

Reflection Paper Murray Text

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## General Overview

The topic of the book *The School of Prayer*, by Andrew Murray, is that we are to pray from our heart and always pray. The first several chapters talked about how we need to learn how to pray from the get go. God, and Jesus, our Lord and God, wants to teach us how to pray. He wants us to learn that we need to pray in the spirit and in truth.

I thought it was interesting that he said we need to pray in spirit and in truth because the Bible says to “worship” in this manner. However, I understand that worship and prayer is interlinked. Without worship, we cannot pray.

And each chapter would point out different characters of God and in ourselves that we need to examine in order to pray correctly. Indeed, we are in the school of prayer - a learning place of how to pray.

I believe that the author wrote this text because we all need to learn how to pray. We lack the ability to get in a quiet place and pray for long hours. It is contrary to our modern society to pray and pray correctly and deeply. It is a practice that must be valued and kept in tact.

I think the author’s main point is to teach us that we need humility and love in our hearts and to pray with honesty. God loves it when we come to him with a contrite heart looking to hear from him.

## Key Points

1) **The quietness of the location where we find God.** This is one of the same key points I used for the Lawrence text. What I find fascinating with this point is that it comes up again in this text. We need to have a quiet place where we can go deep with God and we need a personal relationship with him. Ultimately, our faith is just one on one - it is between God and me.

What touched my heart is that we all need to be individually connected with God and to have a personal relationship with him. It is not about others - it is about God. God says this in the Bible when David says, "It is against you alone that I sinned." Truly, we need to focus on God and God alone in our lives and in prayer. This then becomes a light to the world.

2) **We need to be alone with God.** Truly, this is the same point that came up in the Lawrence text. And what I'm trying to show is that there is commonality between the writers, and that the principles that are taught by Christians overlap - for good reason. This is because Christianity is shared between all people. We need to be alone with God because we cannot have any source of strength except for God alone.

One of the things I'm learning in my leadership class is that we need to have a strong connection with God personally. From this relationship with God, which is individual, does flow our leadership and ministry to others.

## Personal Application

This text taught me that I need to seek God in a quiet place and alone. My relationship with God is so important in my walk in life and with God.

One of the things that I'm learning is that I need to improve my walk with God. And the way that I can do that is to pray and to pray often and to pray deeply. One of the personal challenges that I face is that I have difficulty when I fall asleep. It stems from PTSD from surgery that I had when I was a kid when I broke my leg. I feel so alone and so depressed when I'm on my bed at night time and it is during those times when I feel the darkness of night that I

need to pray and to be honest, even right now I am saying prayer is good. Prayer is good but is it enough? Is it enough? Can prayer really solve all of my problems?

And to this, I must say we pray not because it solves our problems, but we pray because we are desperate for God. We need need God, and we come humbly and contrite to God.

And so this is the true school of prayer where we learned how to humble ourselves and to be crushed by our own sin, and by our own difficulties and to come to God with nothing to offer, but prayers only.

We say to God, “Help me! Help me! I need you!”

One of the things I did not learn from this text is that there is spiritual warfare I may have missed it, but this text was very reformed and very formal. It did not speak of speaking in tongues and of the craziness of the demon world. I must let you know that I'm diagnosed with schizophrenia and because of that I am facing many demons, but I understand that it is true prayer and true love and true endurance that is going to cast out demons it is not some strange formula or spell.

And so we come back to the text of Andrew Murray and we say this is the best way to cast out all of the bad demons.

And so he say with John and with the apostles, “Maranatha; come, Lord Jesus come.”

And one of the things that I'm not sure that Andrew Murray talked about is that God answers prayers. It's one of those things that gets me thinking about, “So does God actually care about my life? And does he hear my prayers?”

And the answer is yes God answers every single one of my prayers.